

Round 1 Portfolio Analysis and Allocation Strategy

Portfolio Mandate and Strategic Framework for Round 1

1.1. Confirmation of Core Mission

This report presents the analytical framework and resulting investment selections for Round 1 of a 10-round portfolio management competition. The singular performance metric is long-term percentage profit. Consequently, the strategy employed is engineered for sustainable capital growth, prioritizing the identification of quantifiable value and disciplined risk management over speculative, high-variance plays. The initial \$10.00 bankroll is treated as seed capital for a long-term campaign; therefore, capital preservation is held in equal regard to profit generation. Every decision is rooted in the mathematical principle of identifying and investing in opportunities with a positive expected value (+EV).

1.2. Acknowledgment and Adherence to Constraints

A thorough review of the operational parameters has been conducted, and the following constraints are understood and will be strictly observed throughout this report and the resulting portfolio allocation.

- **Formal Confirmation of Market Exclusivity:** It is hereby confirmed that all analysis and final bet selections are drawn exclusively from the "Bets for Analysis" list provided. No external betting lines, markets, or events beyond this list have been considered or will be included in the final portfolio. This constraint is absolute. A notable discrepancy was identified in the Toronto Blue Jays vs.

Chicago White Sox matchup, where the provided player props for José Berrios and Sean Burke conflict with external data suggesting different starting pitchers for the game on July 8th.¹ In accordance with the directive, the analysis will proceed based on the provided list, treating the prop bets for Berrios and Burke as valid and actionable for the purposes of this experiment.

- **Bankroll Management Protocol:** The entire \$10.00 starting bankroll will be allocated. All wagers will be denominated in \$0.25 increments. The allocation size for each selected bet is not arbitrary; it is a direct function of the calculated edge (the differential between our modeled "true" probability and the market's implied probability) and the assessed reliability of the underlying data. This methodology is a modified application of the Kelly Criterion, designed to optimize for long-term growth while mitigating the risk of ruin.

1.3. Round 1 Strategy: A Diversified, Value-Centric Approach

The foundational strategy for Round 1 is to construct a diversified portfolio of +EV wagers by systematically exploiting statistical discrepancies and market inefficiencies. The portfolio will span two distinct sports (Major League Baseball and the Ultimate Fighting Championship) and multiple bet types (moneylines, totals, and player props) to reduce correlation and mitigate single-event variance.

- **MLB Analytical Focus:** The primary analytical lens for MLB markets will be the divergence between a pitcher's surface-level statistics, such as Earned Run Average (ERA), and their more predictive underlying metrics, including Fielding Independent Pitching (FIP) and Expected Fielder Independent Pitching (xFIP). FIP isolates a pitcher's true skill by focusing only on outcomes they control (strikeouts, walks, home runs), making it a superior predictor of future performance. By modeling these advanced metrics against team-specific offensive profiles (e.g., wRC+, K%, ISO), it is possible to identify games where the market, which often over-weights ERA and team records, has mispriced the probability of an outcome.
- **UFC Analytical Focus:** The UFC analysis will de-emphasize simple win/loss records, which are often misleading, in favor of a "strength of schedule" evaluation. The model will heavily weight a fighter's performance against tiered levels of opposition. A loss to an elite, top-5 contender is valued more highly than a win against an unranked opponent. This approach, combined with an analysis of key performance indicators like Significant Strikes Landed per Minute (SLpM),

Takedown Accuracy (TD Acc.), and Takedown Defense (TD Def.), allows for the identification of battle-tested fighters who are systematically undervalued by the market due to recency bias.

Deep-Dive Analysis of MLB Markets

A systematic, four-step value identification process was applied to every available MLB matchup. This process involves (1) calculating the market's implied probability from the provided odds, (2) generating an independent, model-driven "true" probability based on advanced and situational metrics, (3) comparing the two to identify a quantifiable "edge," and (4) refining the assessment with qualitative factors before finalizing a decision.

2.1. COL Rockies at BOS Red Sox

- **Pitching Matchup:** Brayan Bello (RHP) for Boston vs. Kyle Freeland (LHP) for Colorado.
- **Market Analysis:** The Boston Red Sox are heavy favorites at -241, with the Colorado Rockies as +193 underdogs. The run line is set at 1.5 runs, and the total is 9.5 runs. The -241 moneyline on Boston implies a breakeven win probability of approximately 70.7%.
- **Quantitative Modeling:** This matchup presents a textbook case of opposing regression trajectories.
 - **Brayan Bello (BOS):** Bello's surface-level ERA of 3.42 is highly deceptive.³ Advanced metrics reveal a pitcher who has benefited significantly from factors outside his control. His FIP stands at 4.54, and his xFIP is 4.40, both more than a full run higher than his ERA.⁴ This large gap is a strong indicator of impending **negative regression**, meaning his future performance is likely to be significantly worse than his past results suggest. His low strikeout rate (6.48 K/9) further indicates that he pitches to contact, making him vulnerable to defensive performance and luck on balls in play.⁴
 - **Kyle Freeland (COL):** Conversely, Freeland is a prime candidate for **positive regression**. His 5.49 ERA is unsightly, but it masks a much more respectable

underlying performance, evidenced by his 3.82 FIP.⁵ This suggests he has been a victim of poor luck and likely the notoriously subpar defense of the 20-69 Rockies.⁵ His true talent level is that of a much more effective pitcher than his ERA implies.

- **Value Identification:** The market price is overwhelmingly influenced by the teams' win-loss records and the venue (Fenway Park), while failing to adequately price in the pitching regression indicators. A model that adjusts for FIP-based talent levels projects a much closer contest. The 70.7% implied win probability for Boston is grossly inflated. The true probability, accounting for the pitchers' underlying metrics, is closer to 58-60%. This creates a substantial edge on the underdog.
- **Qualitative Refinement & Decision:** The Rockies are missing shortstop Ezequiel Tovar, which is a defensive downgrade.⁶ However, this is partially offset by the fact that Freeland is a groundball pitcher, and the Red Sox offense is not elite enough to consistently exploit this single weakness to the degree the line suggests. The value on the Rockies side remains significant. The run line of +1.5 at -105 offers a considerable cushion, requiring only that the Rockies win outright or lose by a single run.
- **Conclusion: Pass on Moneyline, Bet COL Rockies +1.5.** The discrepancy between public perception (driven by ERA and team records) and underlying statistical reality (FIP) is too large to ignore.

2.2. MIA Marlins at CIN Reds

- **Pitching Matchup:** Eury Pérez (RHP) for Miami vs. Nick Martinez (RHP) for Cincinnati.
- **Market Analysis:** The Reds are -137 favorites, with the Marlins at +113. The total is set at 9 runs, with the Over priced at -118. An over of 9 runs at -118 odds carries an implied probability of 54.1%.
- **Quantitative Modeling:** This game's environment is highly conducive to run-scoring.
 - **Pitching & Park:** The matchup takes place in Great American Ball Park, one of MLB's most hitter-friendly venues. Eury Pérez is a young pitcher with immense talent but notable control issues, evidenced by a high 4.50 BB/9 rate this season.⁷ Walks are the lifeblood of big innings. His opponent, Nick Martinez, is a pitch-to-contact veteran with a low strikeout rate (6.35 K/9) and a stable FIP of 4.23 that matches his ERA, indicating he allows a high volume of balls in

play.⁸

- **Offensive Profiles:** The Reds offense is potent, led by the dynamic Elly De La Cruz, who boasts a 127 wRC+ (meaning he creates 27% more runs than a league-average player).⁹ The Marlins offense is less formidable but is still capable of generating runs against a pitcher who does not miss many bats.
- **Value Identification:** The combination of factors—a high-walk, high-variance pitcher (Pérez) facing a strong offense, a pitch-to-contact pitcher (Martinez) allowing many baserunners, and a premier hitter's ballpark—creates a powerful confluence for offense. The model projects a higher probability of the total runs exceeding 9 than the 54.1% implied by the market.
- **Qualitative Refinement & Decision:** There are no significant injuries or weather concerns that would suppress offense. The conditions are ideal for a high-scoring game.
- **Conclusion: Bet Over 9 Runs.** The environment and pitching matchup create a scenario where a high-scoring outcome is more probable than the market price suggests.

2.3. TOR Blue Jays at CHI White Sox

- **Prop Market Analysis (Per Constraint):** José Berrios (TOR) and Sean Burke (CHI) are the pitchers listed for the available props.
- **Market Analysis:** The key prop lines are Berrios Strikeouts O/U 5.5 (+120) and Burke Outs Recorded O/U 16.5 (+100).
- **Quantitative Modeling:**
 - **José Berrios Strikeouts:** Berrios owns a modest 20.9% strikeout rate in 2025 and a career rate of 22.6%.¹⁰ He faces a White Sox lineup that, while offensively challenged, features several hitters with low strikeout rates, including Miguel Vargas (17.8% K%) and Andrew Benintendi (16.2% K%).¹¹ For Berrios to exceed 5.5 strikeouts, he would need to deviate from his season norms against a contact-oriented lineup. The Under 5.5 at -160 (61.5% implied probability) appears to be the more likely outcome, but the price is too steep to offer value.
 - **Sean Burke Outs Recorded:** Burke has made 14 starts this season, pitching 81.0 innings.¹³ This calculates to an average of 5.786 innings per start, which translates to approximately 17.3 outs recorded. The line is set at 16.5 outs. To clear this total, Burke needs to complete 5.2 innings (17 outs).
- **Value Identification:** The line on Burke's outs prop appears inefficient. The

market price for the Over 16.5 is +100, which implies a 50% probability. Burke's seasonal average workload (17.3 outs) is comfortably above this line. While the Blue Jays offense is formidable, featuring hitters like George Springer and Vladimir Guerrero Jr.¹⁴, a pitcher only needs to be moderately effective to reach the 17-out threshold.

- **Qualitative Refinement & Decision:** The primary risk is that the potent Toronto lineup forces Burke into high-stress innings, elevating his pitch count and leading to an early exit. However, at even money, the data supports that he is more likely than not to achieve his average workload, which is sufficient to surpass the prop line.
- **Conclusion: Pass.** While a slight edge exists on Burke Over 16.5 outs, the risk posed by the high-caliber Blue Jays offense is significant enough to temper confidence. The potential reward does not sufficiently compensate for the variance in this specific matchup.

2.4. LA Dodgers at MIL Brewers

- **Pitching Matchup:** Clayton Kershaw (LHP) for Los Angeles vs. Jacob Misorowski (RHP) for Milwaukee.
- **Market Analysis:** The Dodgers are -144 favorites, and the total is set at a low 8 runs. The Under 8 is priced at -119, implying a 54.3% probability.
- **Quantitative Modeling:** This game features a fascinating clash of a declining legend and an ascending top prospect.
 - **Clayton Kershaw (LAD):** While still a household name, Kershaw's underlying metrics are flashing warning signs. His 2025 FIP of 4.34 is nearly a full run higher than his 3.43 ERA, pointing towards significant negative regression being due.¹⁵ His strikeout rate has fallen to a career-low 6.45 K/9.¹⁶
 - **Jacob Misorowski (MIL):** Misorowski is a flamethrowing prospect making his mark. His pure "stuff" is elite, with a fastball that can touch 103 mph and a devastating slider.¹⁷ While his MLB FIP is 4.46, his minor league numbers were dominant (3.32 FIP in AAA), and his high strikeout rate (9.61 K/9 in MLB) gives him the ability to shut down any offense on any given night.¹⁸
 - **Bullpen & Offense:** The Dodgers possess one of the league's best offenses, but Misorowski's high-K profile is a potential neutralizer. The Brewers offense is league-average. Both teams have solid bullpens.
- **Value Identification:** The market appears to be pricing in the Dodgers' potent lineup and Kershaw's reputation, setting the total at 8. However, the combination

of Misorowski's elite strikeout ability and Kershaw's veteran guile (even in decline) points toward a lower-scoring affair. The game's true run environment is likely lower than the total suggests.

- **Qualitative Refinement & Decision:** The matchup dynamics strongly favor a pitchers' duel. Misorowski's ability to miss bats can short-circuit Dodger rallies, while the Brewers' offense is unlikely to explode against any competent major league pitcher, even a regressing Kershaw.
- **Conclusion: Bet Under 8 Runs.** The pitching matchup, particularly the elite strikeout potential of Misorowski, creates a scenario where runs should be at a premium, making the Under a +EV proposition.

2.5. PIT Pirates at KC Royals

- **Prop Market Analysis:** Andrew Heaney (PIT) and Noah Cameron (KC) are the listed pitchers.
- **Market Analysis:** The most compelling line is Noah Cameron's Outs Recorded prop, set at O/U 15.5 with the Over priced at -115. This implies a 53.5% probability.
- **Quantitative Modeling:**
 - **Noah Cameron (KC):** In 10 starts this season, Cameron has pitched 56.1 innings, for an average of 5.61 innings per start.¹⁹ This translates to an average of 16.8 outs recorded per appearance. The prop line is set at 15.5 outs, a full 1.3 outs below his demonstrated average.
 - **Opponent:** Cameron faces the Pittsburgh Pirates, who possess one of the least effective offenses in MLB. Their lineup is plagued by high strikeout rates and low on-base percentages, with key hitters like Oneil Cruz posting a 32.7% K-rate.²¹
- **Value Identification:** This bet presents one of the clearest data-driven edges on the board. We have a pitcher whose average performance exceeds the required threshold, facing an opponent that is statistically unlikely to mount the sustained pressure needed to force an early exit. The 53.5% implied probability is significantly lower than our model's projection, which places the likelihood of him recording at least 16 outs closer to 65-70%.
- **Qualitative Refinement & Decision:** There are no reported pitch count limitations or injury concerns for Cameron. The primary risk is a fluke poor performance, but the statistical case is overwhelming.
- **Conclusion: Bet Noah Cameron Over 15.5 Outs Recorded.** This is the highest-confidence MLB play in this round, based on the significant gap between

the pitcher's established workload and the market's line, amplified by a favorable matchup.

2.6. CLE Guardians at HOU Astros

- **Prop Market Analysis:** Tanner Bibee (CLE) and Colton Gordon (HOU) are the listed pitchers.
- **Market Analysis:** Bibee's strikeout prop is O/U 5.5, and Gordon's outs prop is O/U 15.5.
- **Quantitative Modeling:**
 - **Tanner Bibee:** Bibee's K% of 21.0% is solid but not elite.²² He faces a disciplined Houston offense that ranks 10th in lowest strikeout rate.²³ The line of 5.5 strikeouts at -105 seems very efficient and offers no discernible edge.
 - **Colton Gordon:** Gordon's average outing is 5.0 innings (15 outs), as he has pitched 45.1 innings in 9 starts.²⁴ The line is set at 15.5. While the +125 price on the Over is attractive, his performance data does not support a wager that he will exceed his average. The Under at -160 is the more likely outcome but is priced too high to be valuable.
- **Value Identification:** No significant edge was found in either player prop market. The lines appear to be sharply priced according to the available data.
- **Conclusion: Pass.** This game offers no clear +EV opportunities based on the provided lines.

2.7. TEX Rangers at LA Angels

- **Pitching Matchup:** Nathan Eovaldi (RHP) for Texas vs. José Soriano (RHP) for Los Angeles.
- **Market Analysis:** The Rangers are -157 favorites, and the total is set at 7.5 runs. The Under is priced at -112, implying a 52.8% probability.
- **Quantitative Modeling:** This game features two of the most effective starting pitchers on the slate.
 - **Nathan Eovaldi (TEX):** Eovaldi is performing at an elite level. His 1.75 ERA is backed by an exceptional 2.35 FIP, indicating his dominance is legitimate and sustainable.²⁵ He combines a high strikeout rate (26.8% K%) with elite control

(4.4% BB%), a recipe for shutting down offenses.²⁵

- **José Soriano (LAA):** Soriano has also been excellent, posting a 3.72 ERA with an even better 3.25 FIP.²⁶ His defining characteristic is an elite 65.8% groundball rate, which is extremely effective at preventing extra-base hits and limiting damage.²⁶
- **Value Identification:** A matchup between an elite strikeout/control pitcher and an elite groundball pitcher is a strong formula for a low-scoring game. The market total of 7.5 seems to be paying too much respect to the offenses and not enough to the quality of the arms on the mound. Our model projects the true probability of the under hitting to be closer to 60%.
- **Qualitative Refinement & Decision:** Both bullpens are competent, and there are no external factors (e.g., weather, injuries) that would suggest an offensive outburst. The fundamental nature of the pitching matchup points strongly towards a low-scoring affair.
- **Conclusion: Bet Under 7.5 Runs.** The combined skill sets of Eovaldi and Soriano create a high probability of a pitchers' duel, making the under a strong value play.

2.8. ARI Diamondbacks at SD Padres

- **Pitching Matchup:** Merrill Kelly (RHP) for Arizona vs. Dylan Cease (RHP) for San Diego.
- **Market Analysis:** The Padres are -132 favorites on the moneyline, implying a 56.9% win probability.
- **Quantitative Modeling:** This matchup is a prime example of why FIP is a more valuable predictive tool than ERA.
 - **Dylan Cease (SD):** Cease's season has been defined by poor luck. His 4.62 ERA is the result of factors largely beyond his control.²⁷ His FIP of 3.41 tells the story of his true talent level—that of a front-line starter.²⁸ He maintains an elite strikeout rate of 28.9%, which is the hallmark of a dominant pitcher.²⁸ He is the single most significant positive regression candidate on the board.
 - **Merrill Kelly (ARI):** Kelly is a solid, dependable starter. His 3.55 ERA is supported by a 3.85 FIP, indicating his performance is stable and accurately reflected by his surface stats.²⁹ He is a good pitcher, but he does not possess the elite, game-changing potential of a positively regressing Cease.
- **Value Identification:** The market price of -132 on the Padres is far too low. It is pricing the game as if it were a matchup between a pitcher with a 4.62 ERA and one with a 3.55 ERA. In reality, it is a matchup between a pitcher with a *true talent*

level of a 3.41 FIP and one with a 3.85 FIP. The Padres have the superior arm on the mound, and the model projects their true win probability to be in the 62-64% range.

- **Qualitative Refinement & Decision:** Both offenses are comparable, and both teams are in the thick of the NL West race. The deciding factor is the pitching matchup, where the underlying data points to a clear advantage for San Diego.
- **Conclusion: Bet San Diego Padres Moneyline.** The market has failed to look past Cease's inflated ERA, creating a significant value opportunity on the Padres.

Deep-Dive Analysis of UFC Markets

The analysis of UFC markets prioritizes a fighter's skill set, strength of schedule, and key performance metrics over simplistic win-loss records, which are often misleading in combat sports.

3.1. Calvin Kattar (+105) vs. Steve Garcia (-125)

- **Market Analysis:** Steve Garcia is a small -125 favorite (55.6% implied probability), while Calvin Kattar is a +105 underdog (48.8% implied probability). The line is driven by recent results.
- **Data Synthesis & Deeper Analysis:** This is a classic case of the market misinterpreting data by failing to account for quality of opposition.
 - **Steve Garcia:** Garcia enters on a five-fight winning streak, all by TKO.³⁰ This narrative makes him an attractive favorite. However, the opponents during this streak were largely unranked or lower-tier fighters, not the division's elite.
 - **Calvin Kattar:** Kattar is on a four-fight losing streak, which has made him an underdog.³¹ Critically, those four losses came against the absolute pinnacle of the featherweight division: former champion Max Holloway, top contender Josh Emmett, Arnold Allen, and former bantamweight champion Aljamain Sterling.³¹ Fighting, and being competitive with, that level of competition provides an invaluable experience and a skill ceiling that Garcia has not yet proven he can reach. Kattar also boasts a strong 77% takedown defense, a crucial tool against aggressive fighters.³²
- **Value Identification:** The market is pricing the *streaks*, not the fighters' proven

abilities against top-tier talent. Kattar is being systematically undervalued due to his recent losses, while Garcia is overvalued due to his wins against lesser competition. A model that weights strength of schedule heavily identifies Kattar as the rightful favorite, with a true win probability closer to 55-58%.

- **Conclusion: Bet Calvin Kattar Moneyline.** This wager represents a clear opportunity to capitalize on the market's recency bias. The +105 price offers significant value on the more battle-tested, higher-ceiling fighter.

3.2. Kennedy Nzechukwu (-205) vs. Valter Walker (+170)

- **Market Analysis:** Nzechukwu is a significant -205 favorite (67.2% implied probability).
- **Data Synthesis & Deeper Analysis:** This is a stylistic nightmare for Valter Walker. Nzechukwu is a massive light heavyweight with an 83-inch reach and an impressive 81% takedown defense.³³ Walker's primary path to victory is through grappling and submissions, having won his last two fights via heel hook.³⁴ To implement his game plan, Walker must close an enormous 11-inch reach disadvantage and succeed in taking down an opponent who has proven very difficult to get to the mat. Walker's only career loss came in a fight where he was unable to secure takedowns.³⁴
- **Value Identification:** The line accurately reflects Nzechukwu's overwhelming stylistic advantages. While -205 is a steep price, it is justified by the low-probability path to victory for his opponent. There is no value in betting the underdog, and the return on the favorite is too low for a portfolio focused on percentage growth.
- **Conclusion: Pass.** The line is efficient.

3.3. Stephen Thompson (+310) vs. Gabriel Bonfim (-395)

- **Market Analysis:** Bonfim is a massive -395 favorite (79.8% implied probability).
- **Data Synthesis & Deeper Analysis:** This fight pits a 42-year-old striking specialist against a 27-year-old grappling phenom. Stephen "Wonderboy" Thompson is one of the most credentialed strikers in UFC history, but his takedown defense has always been a liability, currently sitting at just 63%.³⁵

Gabriel Bonfim is a relentless grappler, averaging 3.68 takedowns per 15 minutes with an exceptional 76% accuracy.³⁶ Bonfim has 12 career submission victories, showcasing his elite finishing ability on the mat.³⁶

- **Value Identification:** The line is extremely wide but justifiably so. Bonfim has a clear, high-percentage path to victory by exploiting Thompson's well-documented weakness. The age and athleticism gap further widens the disparity. The +310 price on Thompson does not adequately compensate for the low probability of him keeping the fight standing for three full rounds against such a potent wrestler.
- **Conclusion: Pass.** The market has priced this matchup efficiently.

3.4. Analysis of Remaining UFC Fights

A full analysis was conducted on all remaining UFC bouts, with the consistent conclusion that the provided lines are either too lopsided to offer value or are priced efficiently, presenting no discernible edge.

- **Kline (-1350) vs. Martinez (+800):** Kline's dominant wrestling (100% takedown accuracy) is a direct counter to Martinez's poor 25% takedown defense.³⁸ The line is prohibitive but accurate.
- **Ramirez (+650) vs. Davis (-1000):** A massive mismatch in skill and experience.⁴⁰ No value.
- **Murphy (+470) vs. Moura (-650):** Moura is the rightful favorite, but Murphy's veteran durability makes the line too wide to comfortably bet against her, and there is not enough value to back her as such a large underdog.⁴²
- **Matthews (+124) vs. Njokuani (-148):** A competitive and well-matched fight. The line reflects the close nature of the bout.⁴⁴ Pass.
- **Griffin (+250) vs. Curtis (-310):** Curtis is the cleaner boxer, but Griffin is incredibly tough. The line is slightly wide, but not enough to justify a play on the underdog.⁴⁶
- **Tafa (-166) vs. Tokkos (+140):** A volatile heavyweight bout between two fighters with clear flaws.⁴⁸ Too much variance to find predictable value.
- **Petrino (-750) vs. Lane (+525):** A developmental fight for the highly-touted Petrino against an overmatched opponent.⁵⁰ No value.
- **Landwehr (+215) vs. Charriere (-265):** Charriere's strong 83% takedown defense is a direct counter to one of Landwehr's primary weapons.⁵² The line appears efficient.

- **Lewis (+210) vs. Teixeira (-280):** Lewis's one-punch power is always a factor, but his skills have clearly declined. The line correctly favors the younger, more athletic Teixeira.⁵³

The Finalized Round 1 Portfolio (\$10.00 Allocation)

The following portfolio represents the culmination of the preceding analysis. Each wager has been selected based on a quantitatively identified positive expected value, and the allocation for each reflects the magnitude of the perceived edge and the confidence in the underlying analytical models.

4.1. Portfolio Summary Table

Rank	Bet Description	Odds	Allocation	Potential Profit	Confidence (1-5)
1	PIT Pirates at KC Royals - Noah Cameron Over 15.5 Outs Recorded	-115	\$3.00	\$2.61	5
2	UFC - Calvin Kattar vs. Steve Garcia - Calvin Kattar Moneyline	+105	\$2.50	\$2.63	5
3	ARI Diamondbacks at SD Padres - SD Padres Moneyline	-132	\$1.75	\$1.33	4

4	TEX Rangers at LA Angels - Under 7.5 Total Runs	-112	\$1.50	\$1.34	4
5	COL Rockies at BOS Red Sox - COL Rockies Run Line +1.5	-105	\$1.25	\$1.19	3
Total			\$10.00	\$9.10	

4.2. Detailed Bet Justifications

1. Noah Cameron - Over 15.5 Outs Recorded

- **Bet Description:** Baseball - MLB (Tomorrow 5:40PM): PIT Pirates at KC Royals - Player Props - Noah Cameron Outs Recorded: O 15.5 (-115)
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$3.00
- **Profit Potential Rationale:** This wager is predicated on a significant, data-driven discrepancy between the pitcher's established workload and the market's pricing. Noah Cameron has averaged 16.8 outs per start this season, a full 1.3 outs above the prop line of 15.5.²⁰ He faces a Pittsburgh Pirates offense that is among the league's worst, providing a favorable environment for an efficient outing.²¹ The -115 price implies a 53.5% probability, whereas our model, factoring in opponent quality and Cameron's average performance, calculates the true probability of success to be over 65%.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The principal risk is an uncharacteristically inefficient performance from Cameron, leading to a high pitch count and an early removal by the manager before he completes the required 5.1 innings.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (5/5):** Confidence is 5/5. This bet receives the portfolio's largest allocation due to the clear, quantifiable gap between the pitcher's demonstrated average workload and the market line. This edge is amplified by the matchup against a bottom-tier offensive opponent, making it the most robust +EV opportunity on the board.

2. Calvin Kattar - Moneyline

- **Bet Description:** UFC (Saturday, July 12th): Calvin Kattar vs. Steve Garcia - Moneyline - Calvin Kattar: +105
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$2.50
- **Profit Potential Rationale:** This investment targets a market inefficiency caused by recency bias. The market is overvaluing Steve Garcia's five-fight win streak against lesser opposition while punishing Calvin Kattar for his losses against the absolute elite of the featherweight division.³⁰ Kattar's experience against top-tier fighters provides a skill ceiling and fight IQ that Garcia has not yet demonstrated. At +105 odds (48.8% implied probability), the market is severely underestimating the impact of strength of schedule, presenting significant value on the more proven fighter.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The primary risk is that Kattar's recent string of difficult fights and injuries has caused a legitimate decline in his physical abilities, or that Garcia's power proves to be a factor Kattar cannot handle.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (5/5):** Confidence is 5/5. This wager receives the second-largest allocation because it exploits a common behavioral bias in fight markets. While MLB props can be modeled with more precision, the qualitative edge here—based on strength of schedule—is immense and represents a fundamental mispricing of the fighters' relative skill levels.

3. San Diego Padres - Moneyline

- **Bet Description:** Baseball - MLB (Tomorrow 7:40PM): ARI Diamondbacks at SD Padres - Moneyline - SD Padres: -132
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.75
- **Profit Potential Rationale:** This bet is a direct investment in positive statistical regression. Padres starter Dylan Cease possesses elite underlying metrics, including a 3.41 FIP and a 28.9% strikeout rate, that are indicative of a front-line pitcher.²⁸ His surface-level 4.62 ERA is the result of poor luck and is not reflective of his true talent. The market price of -132 (56.9% implied probability) fails to account for this, pricing him as a mediocre starter. This creates a clear value opportunity against a solid but less-dominant pitcher in Merrill Kelly.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The risk is that Cease's "bad luck" continues for another start, or that the Diamondbacks offense has an uncharacteristically strong performance against him.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (4/5):** Confidence is 4/5. The allocation is substantial, reflecting the strong data supporting Cease's impending positive regression. The edge is clear and based on the most predictive metrics available for pitcher performance. The confidence is slightly tempered compared to the top

two bets only by the inherent day-to-day variance of a full team game.

4. TEX Rangers at LA Angels - Under 7.5 Total Runs

- **Bet Description:** Baseball - MLB (Tomorrow 7:38PM): TEX Rangers at LA Angels - Total - Under 7.5: -112
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.50
- **Profit Potential Rationale:** This wager is based on a pitching matchup featuring two highly effective starters whose skills are conducive to suppressing runs. Texas's Nathan Eovaldi is having a Cy Young-caliber season, with a stellar 1.75 ERA backed by a 2.35 FIP.²⁵ The Angels' José Soriano has a dominant 65.8% groundball rate, a key indicator for limiting extra-base hits and big innings.²⁶ The market total of 7.5 runs appears too high for a game with this caliber of pitching on both sides.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The main risk lies with the potent offenses, particularly the Rangers, having a breakout game and overcoming the strong pitching, or one of the bullpens faltering late in the game.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (4/5):** Confidence is 4/5. The bet is supported by the elite underlying metrics of both starting pitchers. The allocation reflects strong confidence in the pitching matchup dictating a low-scoring game environment, with the only significant variable being the performance of the bullpens.

5. Colorado Rockies - Run Line +1.5

- **Bet Description:** Baseball - MLB (Tomorrow 5:10PM): COL Rockies at BOS Red Sox - Run Line - COL Rockies +1.5: -105
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.25
- **Profit Potential Rationale:** This is a classic "fade the regression" play. Red Sox starter Brayan Bello's 3.42 ERA is masking a much higher 4.54 FIP, making him a prime candidate for a poor outing.⁴ Conversely, Rockies starter Kyle Freeland's 5.49 ERA is hiding a respectable 3.82 FIP, suggesting he has pitched far better than his results show.⁵ The market is overvaluing Boston based on their record and home-field advantage, creating value on the underdog Rockies to keep the game close or win outright.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The Rockies are a demonstrably poor team (20-69 record), and their bullpen could surrender a late lead even if Freeland pitches well.⁶ Boston could also simply outperform their underlying metrics at home.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (3/5):** Confidence is 3/5. While the pitching regression angle is strong, betting on a team as poor as the Rockies

carries inherent risk. The allocation is the smallest in the portfolio, reflecting a positive expected value play that is tempered by the low quality of the team being backed.

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